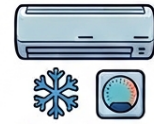


ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

HVAC & Refrigeration English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, and refrigeration technicians, supervised apprentices, service coordinators, and mechanical crew leads.

Fictional workplace-language practice, not heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, or refrigeration (HVACR) training, equipment-operation advice, food-safety advice, or warranty interpretation. All case facts, products, readings, ratings, incidents, and schedules are invented. No refrigerant handling, charging, recovery, electrical operation, diagnostic testing, repair, installation, or control-adjustment procedures are taught. Qualified specialists and applicable site procedures govern technical decisions; product-safety and stock decisions remain with the responsible site lead. No universal code or permit requirements are asserted. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of the invented cases.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Clarifying comfort complaints and thermostat readings

Separate a control target, a temperature observation, and a comfort complaint.

02 Identifying equipment and linked components

Resolve equipment identity using existing records and clear references.

03 Explaining airflow and distribution reports

Explain air-distribution terms without inferring performance from a label.

04 Checking equipment ratings and refrigerant references

Explain why matching numbers or component labels do not establish equivalent systems.

05 Reporting moisture, symptoms, and service findings

Distinguish a new report, an earlier finding, and a tentative diagnosis.

06 Discussing refrigeration alarms and temperature records

Explain a refrigeration record without issuing food-safety advice.

07 Coordinating ductwork, access, and changes

Negotiate a relocation without assuming the visible component is the whole job.

08 Handing over commissioning and maintenance information

Hand over records without making deferred work or mismatched manuals disappear.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Clarifying comfort complaints and thermostat readings

Separate a control target, a temperature observation, and a comfort complaint.

CASE

An office manager says the meeting room is 22 degrees Celsius. The number is the thermostat setpoint, not a confirmed ambient-temperature reading. Staff report feeling warm there after 14:00. No cause or equipment fault has been established.

Teach this move

A thermostat display may show different values. Ask what the existing label says rather than directing control changes. Comfort descriptions are useful information, but they do not by themselves identify a system fault.

Vocabulary to check: thermostat, setpoint, ambient temperature, thermal zone.

Model response

Is 22 degrees the target shown on the thermostat, or a measured room-temperature reading? I will record it as the setpoint if that is the display label. The staff's report concerns feeling warm in the meeting-room zone after 14:00. We still need to distinguish that comfort report from measured conditions and any technical finding.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision avoids treating a requested value as a measurement.

Second-round challenge

The manager asks whether lowering the setting will solve the complaint. Keep the exchange to information gathering, not operating advice.

Language-check answers

1. B - setpoint Correct. Setpoint identifies the target requested by the control.
2. A - after Correct. The report begins after the stated time.

05 • Conversations

1. Twenty-two is the target - A technician clarifies the fictional meeting-room complaint with the office manager.

2. Warm at one desk, not the whole floor - A technician checks a comfort report with a facilities contact.

3. The guest says stuffy - A technician clarifies a hotel's comfort wording with its duty manager.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Celsius or Fahrenheit?

A hotel report for Room 215 records a displayed target of 72 without units. The guest's existing photo shows degrees Fahrenheit and labels the value target, with no actual room-temperature reading. The service record otherwise uses Celsius.

Role A: Technician: clarify units and target versus measurement without adjusting controls.

Role B: Duty manager: provide the existing photo and the room number.

Possible opening: Does the photo identify the units and whether this is the target or room reading?

Success checks

- Identify Fahrenheit.
- Preserve target status.
- Keep units explicit when relaying the number.

Add a complication: The manager wants the unit label omitted because everyone will know.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Identifying equipment and linked components

Resolve equipment identity using existing records and clear references.

CASE

A school request names AC-4, but the roof plan labels outdoor unit CU-4 and the indoor equipment register labels air handler AH-4. Their relationship is not confirmed. The facilities manager has the equipment register; learners must not access a roof or inspect equipment to obtain information.

Teach this move

Site asset tags, manufacturer model numbers, and serial numbers identify different things. Similar suffixes do not prove components are paired. Work from supplied records; do not ask learners to access plant, roofs, or enclosed machinery.

Vocabulary to check: air handler, condensing unit, evaporator, asset tag.

Model response

Could you confirm which asset AC-4 refers to in the request? The records list outdoor unit CU-4 and air handler AH-4, but their matching numbers do not establish that they serve the same system. Please provide the relevant equipment-register entries so we can verify the relationship before attaching the service history.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision keeps a convenient naming pattern from becoming a technical finding.

Second-round challenge

The manager says a photograph of a different site's unit looks identical. Explain why appearance is not an asset reference.

Language-check answers

1. A - asset tag Correct. An asset tag is the site's equipment identifier.
2. D - do not establish Correct. Similar identifiers do not confirm the actual pairing.

05 · Conversations

1. Which number belongs to which unit? - A technician reviews the school's AC-4 request with the facilities manager.
2. The model repeats, the serial does not - A technician checks a parts enquiry with a service coordinator.
3. The evaporator is not the whole system - A technician explains a refrigerator service record to a cafe manager.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The removed unit still appears in the register

The register lists removed asset AH-2, but a handover note records its replacement AH-2A, fictional model Air-Q40, serial AQ-0618. The service booking still names AH-2. The facilities contact has the note; no equipment inspection is needed for this conversation.

Role A: Technician: reconcile the booking with the documented replacement.

Role B: Facilities contact: provide the handover note without guessing that both labels are current.

Possible opening: Does this booking concern the removed AH-2 or the replacement identified as AH-2A?

Success checks

- Identify the replacement clearly.
- Retain the old asset history separately.
- Confirm the service booking references the current item.

Add a complication: The scheduler wants to erase the old asset history.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Explaining airflow and distribution reports

Explain air-distribution terms without inferring performance from a label.

CASE

A client calls both ceiling openings air-conditioning outlets. The current drawing identifies S3 as supply air and R2 as return air. The client reports discomfort below S3 but provides no airflow measurements. The technician must explain the labels without diagnosing poor performance or prescribing adjustments.

Teach this move

Supply and return describe direction and function. Airflow and static pressure are different quantities requiring stated measurement context. Do not teach damper adjustment, testing steps, or conclusions from invented limits.

Vocabulary to check: supply air, return air, airflow, static pressure.

Model response

On this drawing, S3 delivers supply air into the room, while R2 draws return air back toward the system. They are not interchangeable outlet labels. Your discomfort below S3 is useful location information, but it does not by itself establish an airflow value or a cause. We can refer the report with those references clearly identified.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction uses the documented functions rather than treating every opening alike.

Second-round challenge

The client wants a control adjustment immediately. Keep the response to the documented labels and the need for assessment.

Language-check answers

1. D - return air Correct. Return air is drawn back from the served room.
2. C - comparable Correct. 'Comparable' describes conditions suitable for a fair comparison.

05 • Conversations

1. Supply S3 and return R2 - A technician explains two ceiling references to a client.

2. Different units on the two reports - A technician checks a comparison with a facilities analyst.
3. The return opening is missing from the furniture plan - A technician and interior coordinator review a new office arrangement.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One reading has no location

A report lists 120 and 150 liters per second but omits the measured terminal references, meaning the room openings measured. The client attributes 150 to complaint location S5 without evidence. The original measurement points and conditions remain unverified.

Role A: Technician: ask the report author to identify the measurement point.

Role B: Client: you have the report but no marked plan.

Possible opening: Which terminal does this reading belong to, and where is that recorded?

Success checks

- Keep the reading unassigned until verified.
- Separate perceived draught from measured quantity.
- Request the matching point reference and units.

Add a complication: The client assumes the largest listed value must be S5 because it feels draughty.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Checking equipment ratings and refrigerant references

Explain why matching numbers or component labels do not establish equivalent systems.

CASE

Two fictional proposals both say 5 kilowatts, but proposal A labels that cooling capacity and proposal B labels it electrical input. The client calls them equal-size systems. Full data sheets and equipment pairings are not supplied. No selection is approved.

Teach this move

Capacity and electrical input can use the same unit while describing different quantities. A refrigerant designation is an identifier, not a handling instruction or proof of interchangeability. Use complete product information for specialist review.

Vocabulary to check: nameplate, cooling capacity, refrigerant designation, matched system.

Model response

The two 5-kilowatt figures describe different quantities. Proposal A states cooling capacity, while proposal B states electrical input. We cannot treat them as equal-capacity systems from those numbers. Please obtain the full data sheets, rating conditions, and proposed component pairings so the reviewer can compare like for like before we discuss a selection.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The correction distinguishes quantities before comparing values.

Second-round challenge

The seller says the refrigerant designation matches. Explain why that alone does not establish a matched system.

Language-check answers

1. C - cooling capacity Correct. Cooling capacity describes the rate of heat removal under stated conditions.
2. B - equipment pairing Correct. Equipment pairing identifies the component combination requiring compatibility verification.

05 · Conversations

1. Five kilowatts of what? - A technician compares two incomplete proposals with a client.
2. A missing suffix on the nameplate record - A technician clarifies a replacement enquiry with a parts coordinator.
3. The outdoor unit alone has a quoted rating - A technician and purchaser discuss an incomplete equipment quotation.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A bigger rating is treated as a design decision

A client compares fictional catalog options rated at 6 and 8 kilowatts cooling capacity and prefers 8 because bigger sounds better. Rating conditions have not been reconciled. No cooling-load assessment, meaning assessment of the building's cooling demand, is supplied.

Role A: Technician: separate rated capacity from suitability for the building.

Role B: Client: you can arrange a qualified assessment before selecting equipment.

Possible opening: The larger rating describes the unit, but what assessment establishes this building's requirement?

Success checks

- Keep capacity and building demand distinct.
- Avoid recommending a size from catalog numbers.
- State that the discount does not establish suitability.

Add a complication: The seller offers a discount that expires soon.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reporting moisture, symptoms, and service findings

Distinguish a new report, an earlier finding, and a tentative diagnosis.

CASE

A client reports water near air handler AH-6 at 15:00 yesterday. Today's supplied visit note says the nearby floor is dry and the source was not identified. An earlier log mentions a drain-pan concern but does not establish a link. No learner is asked to inspect equipment.

Teach this move

A previous drain-pan concern does not prove a new wet-floor report shares its cause. Condensate is a type of moisture, not a diagnosis of every puddle. Discuss supplied observations without teaching investigation or repair.

Vocabulary to check: condensate, drain pan, service log, provisional diagnosis.

Model response

The supplied visit note records a dry floor today, not a confirmed resolution of yesterday's report. The earlier drain-pan entry may be relevant history, but it does not establish the current source. I will link the dated reports to AH-6 and keep any explanation provisional until the technical reviewer confirms what the evidence supports.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision links the history without inventing a repeated cause.

Second-round challenge

The client suggests replacing the unit immediately. Explain the difference between a concern requiring assessment and an established replacement need.

Language-check answers

1. B - provisional diagnosis Correct. Provisional identifies an explanation still awaiting confirmation.
2. A - dry Correct. Dry is the observed condition recorded in the note.

05 · Conversations

1. Yesterday's water and today's dry floor - A technician explains the supplied AH-6 notes to the client.
2. An old repair appears under the wrong tag - A technician queries a service-log entry with a coordinator.
3. Noise reported only during the morning meeting - A technician gathers an existing noise account from a workplace manager.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A stain is noticed after a service visit

A client notices a ceiling mark above the corridor outside Meeting Room C on Friday after Wednesday's visit to air handler AH-9. No earlier photograph covers that area. The visit record identifies no moisture finding, and the cause is unknown.

Role A: Technician: acknowledge timing while distinguishing it from proven cause.

Role B: Client: you want a factual review, not an unsupported blame statement.

Possible opening: You noticed the mark Friday; can we identify its location and preserve that timing accurately?

Success checks

- Acknowledge the concern.
- Separate discovery date from cause.
- Agree a review using the available records.

Add a complication: The client asks you to state that Wednesday's service caused it.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Discussing refrigeration alarms and temperature records

Explain a refrigeration record without issuing food-safety advice.

CASE

A fictional cafe cabinet display recorded 8 degrees Celsius at 06:10. Product temperatures were not supplied. An alarm-history entry has the same time as a scheduled defrost entry, but the cause and duration are unconfirmed. The cafe manager asks whether the food is safe. The responsible food-safety lead must decide under the site's procedures.

Teach this move

An air or sensor reading is not automatically a product-temperature result. A defrost entry does not make an alarm harmless by definition. Preserve records and refer stock decisions promptly to the responsible site specialist; do not supply temperature thresholds or operating changes.

Vocabulary to check: defrost cycle, cabinet temperature, product temperature, alarm history.

Model response

The 8-degree value is a cabinet reading at 06:10, not a supplied product-temperature result. The alarm and scheduled defrost entries share a timestamp, but that does not establish the cause or duration. I cannot decide food safety from this record. Please involve your food-safety lead while we clarify the equipment history.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision removes an unsupported cause and food-safety assurance.

Second-round challenge

The manager asks for a guarantee that the stock can be sold. Decline that judgment and identify the food-safety lead while preserving the equipment enquiry.

Language-check answers

1. A - product-temperature Correct. No product-temperature result has been supplied.
2. D - but Correct. 'But' preserves the distinction between timing and cause.

05 · Conversations

1. The cabinet reading is not the product reading - A refrigeration technician discusses the fictional cafe log with its manager.
2. Two clocks disagree - A technician clarifies refrigeration event times with a shop supervisor.
3. An acknowledged alarm is not a resolved condition - A technician explains an alarm-history label to a facilities client.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The minimum and maximum lack a period

A summary for cabinet C6 gives a minimum of 2 and maximum of 8 degrees Celsius but omits the recording period and sensor location. No product temperatures are supplied. The stock lead asks how long products were outside their required conditions; this summary cannot establish that.

Role A: Technician: identify what the equipment summary can and cannot establish.

Role B: Manager: retrieve the full existing log and involve the stock lead.

Possible opening: What period and sensor location do these minimum and maximum values cover?

Success checks

- Request the missing context.
- Do not infer product temperature or duration.
- Keep the stock decision with the responsible lead.

Add a complication: The manager wants to treat the maximum as the temperature of every stored item.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Coordinating ductwork, access, and changes

Negotiate a relocation without assuming the visible component is the whole job.

CASE

An office client wants a supply grille moved because it conflicts visually with a pendant light. The proposal has not assessed ductwork, ceiling restoration, service access, price, or timing. The client can retain the current reviewed layout or request a coordinated change proposal.

Teach this move

A small visible change can affect concealed work and another trade's finishes. Name those possible dependencies without inventing their extent. Service clearance is project- and equipment-specific; do not offer universal dimensions.

Vocabulary to check: ductwork, grille, service clearance, change proposal.

Model response

We can retain the current reviewed layout or request a coordinated proposal for the grille relocation. The visible grille is only part of the change; ductwork, ceiling restoration, access, cost, and timing may also need review. Could you provide the revised lighting position so both layouts can be assessed together before any change is agreed?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision avoids claiming simplicity from the visible part alone.

Second-round challenge

The decorator quotes ceiling restoration separately. Explain the combined comparison without assuming the original mechanical price includes it.

Language-check answers

1. D - ductwork Correct. Ductwork carries air between equipment and served spaces.
2. C - pending Correct. Pending review means the review has not yet been completed.

05 · Conversations

1. The grille is only the visible part - A technician discusses a proposed ceiling change with the office client.
2. The new cabinet occupies service space - A technician and facilities planner review furniture near equipment.
3. The ceiling contractor's scope is separate - A technician clarifies a relocation estimate with a project coordinator.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A maintenance visit meets a ceiling closure

A service visit is proposed for Thursday, but the ceiling contractor plans to close the relevant area Wednesday. Access arrangements have not been coordinated; neither date is final.

Role A: Technician: identify the dependency and request a joint scheduling decision.

Role B: Coordinator: you can speak to both contractors and the occupier.

Possible opening: Can we reconcile the service visit with the proposed ceiling closure before confirming either date?

Success checks

- Name both proposed activities and dates.
- Keep the access question explicit.
- Agree who obtains a coordinated sequence.

Add a complication: The coordinator says the service team can work out access on arrival.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Handing over commissioning and maintenance information

Hand over records without making deferred work or mismatched manuals disappear.

CASE

A fictional office system's commissioning report is received but lists a deferred seasonal check. The maintenance sheet names the wrong model. Coordinator Nia accepts document correction and will update the client Friday. The seasonal-check date is not booked, and responsibility for scheduling it has not yet been confirmed. Who will arrange the check remains an open question. No overall performance or warranty conclusion is supplied.

Teach this move

A report may contain completed activities and explicit limitations. Match maintenance information to the actual equipment and its stated source. Do not invent intervals, interpret warranty rights, or turn a status call into a service booking.

Vocabulary to check: commissioning report, maintenance interval, warranty exclusion, outstanding item.

Model response

Nia has accepted follow-up on the maintenance sheet, which names the wrong model, and will update you Friday. We haven't confirmed who will book the seasonal check; that question remains open. Could we confirm who will take responsibility for booking it? The commissioning report is received, but the check remains deferred and no date is booked.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision retains the report's stated limitation.

Second-round challenge

The supplier sends a generic family manual. Keep applicability pending verification rather than closing the correction merely because a file arrived.

Language-check answers

1. C - deferred Correct. Deferred means postponed rather than completed.

2. B - not Correct. 'Not' preserves the distinction between call and attendance.

05 • Conversations

1. The report includes a deferred check - A technician hands over the fictional commissioning information to the client.

2. A generic manual needs an applicability check - A technician discusses a received manual with a facilities assistant.

3. A warranty exclusion is not a diagnosis - A technician clarifies a client's question about a warranty document.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 • Say it: second scenario | The follow-up owner changes

Nia is leaving before a maintenance-sheet mismatch is resolved. Installed asset AH-12 is fictional model Air-Q50; the received sheet names Air-Q30. Applicability has not been confirmed. Ellis accepts the supplier query and can update the client Tuesday. The separate seasonal check remains unbooked.

Role A: Outgoing technician: transfer the mismatch between installed AH-12, model Air-Q50, and the sheet naming Air-Q30.

Role B: Ellis: repeat asset AH-12 and model Air-Q50, accept the supplier follow-up, and distinguish it from booking the seasonal check.

Possible opening: Can you accept the maintenance-sheet query and keep the seasonal-check booking separate?

Success checks

- Confirm Ellis accepts the maintenance-document query.
- Repeat installed model Air-Q50 and distinguish the sheet's Air-Q30 reference.
- State that Tuesday is an update and the seasonal visit remains unbooked.

Add a complication: The client assumes the new contact has also booked the seasonal visit.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional workplace-language practice, not heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, or refrigeration (HVACR) training, equipment-operation advice, food-safety advice, or warranty interpretation. All case facts, products, readings, ratings, incidents, and schedules are invented. No refrigerant handling, charging, recovery, electrical operation, diagnostic testing, repair, installation, or control-adjustment procedures are taught. Qualified specialists and applicable site procedures govern technical decisions; product-safety and stock decisions remain with the responsible site lead. No universal code or permit requirements are asserted. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of the invented cases.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Heating, Air Conditioning, and Refrigeration Mechanics and Installers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/installation-maintenance-and-repair/heating-air-conditioning-and-refrigeration-mechanics-and-installers.htm>

O*NET OnLine: Heating, Air Conditioning, and Refrigeration Mechanics and Installers (49-9021.00), U.S. Department of Labor-sponsored occupational profile

<https://www.onetonline.org/link/summary/49-9021.00>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: HVAC & Refrigeration English

Professional audience: Heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, and refrigeration technicians, supervised apprentices, service coordinators, and mechanical crew leads

Scope: Fictional workplace-language practice, not heating, ventilation, air-conditioning, or refrigeration (HVACR) training, equipment-operation advice, food-safety advice, or warranty interpretation. All case facts, products, readings, ratings, incidents, and schedules are invented. No refrigerant handling, charging, recovery, electrical operation, diagnostic testing, repair, installation, or control-adjustment procedures are taught. Qualified specialists and applicable site procedures govern technical decisions; product-safety and stock decisions remain with the responsible site lead. No universal code or permit requirements are asserted. Sources establish occupational context, not endorsement of the invented cases.

Lesson 01: Clarifying comfort complaints and thermostat readings

Original fictional case: An office manager says the meeting room is 22 degrees Celsius. The number is the thermostat setpoint, not a confirmed ambient-temperature reading. Staff report feeling warm there after 14:00. No cause or equipment fault has been established.

Language workshop: Ask which number is being reported

Communication goal: Separate a control target, a temperature observation, and a comfort complaint.

Language guidance: A thermostat display may show different values. Ask what the existing label says rather than directing control changes. Comfort descriptions are useful information, but they do not by themselves identify a system fault.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Does that display show ___ or ___? / The complaint concerns ___ after ___ . / The target is ___; the measured condition remains ___.

Vocabulary: thermostat: A device that senses temperature and requests heating or cooling according to its configured controls. / setpoint: The target value requested by a control, distinct from a measured condition.

/ ambient temperature: The temperature of the surrounding air at an identified place and time. / thermal zone: An area treated as a unit for heating or cooling control or assessment.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are the manager. The display says target 22 degrees Celsius, and staff feel warm after 14:00.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The manager asks whether lowering the setting will solve the complaint. Keep the exchange to information gathering, not operating advice.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Is 22 degrees the target shown on the thermostat, or a measured room-temperature reading? I will record it as the setpoint if that is the display label. The staff's report concerns feeling warm in the meeting-room zone after 14:00. We still need to distinguish that comfort report from measured conditions and any technical finding.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt a supported occupational language lesson

1. Ask for learner support needs, group size and time. Offer two B2 learners and 20 minutes as a default and wait for confirmation.
2. Use the reference's real language goal, terms and case facts. Provide a timed plan containing reading, four-choice dialogue gaps, scaffolded speaking, focused feedback and a retry. No activity may require open-ended writing.
3. Give two separate speaking role cards with known facts, an objective, a possible opening, one question to resolve and three success checks. Put model responses in a separate teacher section. Label invented complications and preserve uncertainty.
4. Include four original gap-fill exchanges with four plausible options each and exactly one answer. Provide option-specific explanations separately. B1 support adds a word bank and frames; C1 stretch uses more nuanced choices and spoken follow-up, not essays. Include solo rehearsal of both roles.
5. Check facts, terminology, answer uniqueness and timing before presenting the plan. Finish with a four-choice exit question and an optional spoken retry. Do not certify proficiency or teach professional procedures.

END PROMPT

Adjust tone and register

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TASK: Match the wording to the listener

1. Quote one actual utterance from the reference. Identify its purpose, audience and degree of certainty. Offer a colleague, supervisor or outside customer as the new listener. Wait for my selection.
2. Supply four possible versions A-D and a specific constraint, such as explaining an unfamiliar abbreviation without changing a pending decision into approval. Make exactly one version satisfy all constraints. Wait for my choice.
3. Explain the strengths and limitations of every option. Treat valid stylistic alternatives as alternatives, not mistakes; rewrite an ambiguous question instead of rejecting reasonable English. Avoid national stereotypes.
4. Continue with three short, role-labelled exchanges in which I select the missing reply from four choices. Include a clarification and a disagreement. Wait after each item and invite a spoken rehearsal after feedback.
5. Finish with two complete model exchanges for different listeners. Identify what changed and what stayed the same. Do not assign open-ended writing.

END PROMPT